

DANIEL OLSHANSKY

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ABOUT ME

12+ years of professional engineering experience with 4+ years in technical leadership owning strategic product direction, building small teams, and managing cross-organizational requirements. My work has spanned social media, augmented reality cloud infrastructure, autonomous vehicle AI evals, blockchain consensus infrastructure, and agentic payment systems. I enjoy operating in ambiguous, high-stakes environments where tradeoffs need to be made and the learnings along the way pave the road to success.

My personal mission is to enable every individual to achieve their full potential. The hard skills I leverage to make that happen is by approaching opportunities through a systems lens, and using software to solve problems at the interface of the digital and physical.

Motto: Have my future self inspire my present self.

Drive: Build products that expand what people believe is possible.

Superpower: Rapidly synthesizing context and adapting across unfamiliar domains.

Approach: Deep focus with fast execution; gather context continuously; make tradeoffs explicit.

Mindset: Physical & mental discipline; calm under pressure.

Craft: Bridge engineering rigor, research curiosity, and product judgment into durable leverage.

EXPERIENCE

CTO @ Grove

2025 - Present

- **Context:** Early-stage product where onboarding speed and immediate user value determine survival.
- **Built:** Creator monetization platform enabling micropayments from both AI agents and human audiences.
- **Impact:** Shipped core payment and onboarding primitives; acquiring first creators and agent integrators.

BreakingGround (Founder, AI Consulting)

2026 - Present

- **Context:** Building on GetSoils (2021 - 2022), a construction-soil marketplace for geotech firms (IP sold).
- **Results:** Part-time AI consulting for geotech: fine-tuning VLMs (Thinking Machines' Tinker) for soil analysis, datasette.io based data exploration, workflow automation, and data governance.

Head of Protocol @ Pocket Network (CTO @ Grove Labs)

2022 - 2025

- **Context:** Decentralized protocol requiring incentive alignment across a small core team, dozens of exchanges, and hundreds of ecosystem stakeholders.
- **Built:** Led R&D for a permissionless API marketplace serving decentralized data access at scale.
- **Impact:** Launched a \$100M+ protocol serving 1B+ daily requests; rebuilt and led the 6-person core protocol team through a CTO transition.

Founder & CEO @ GetSoils

2021 - 2022

A marketplace for excess construction soils. Reached a few hundred users while learning that the adoption curve for traditional industries requires a different approach.

Senior Software Engineer @ Waymo (Alphabet)

2020 - 2022

- **Context:** Planner evaluation needed reliable, reproducible datasets; none existed org-wide. Focused on reducing engineering overhead for research teams.
- **Built:** Labeling infrastructure, visualization tools, and a test-set corpus for the Planner Eval team.
- **Impact:** Drove the org-wide test-set initiative across real and synthetic datasets, adopted by hundreds of engineers and data scientists.

Lead Software Engineer @ Magic Leap

2016 - 2020

- **Context:** Hardware startup navigating competing scope across cloud, device, and research teams in an overcapitalized environment.
- **Built:** Cloud-based digital twin using raw sensor data for object recognition, sparse mapping, and dense mapping.
- **Impact:** Shipped Magic Leap One and the Shared World SDK; led 5 engineers; co-authored 15+ patents.

Software Engineer @ Twitter

2014 - 2016

- **Context:** High-scale consumer platform; first professional engineering role.
- **Built:** Features across mobile, web, and backend on the VIT and Media teams.
- **Impact:** Shipped GIF search, custom timelines, and vetted account features to 10s of millions of daily users.

EDUCATION

Internships

2011 - 2013

ModiFace (mobile computer vision), Twitter (iOS), Google (Android)

University of Toronto

2010 - 2014

B.A.Sc in Engineering Science, Electrical & Computer Engineering • GPA: 3.84 • Dean's List • NΨ 1T4

Thesis: Accelerating PCA for fMRI analysis using GPUs and MapReduce

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES (all items below are hyperlinked)

Writing: Posts, Thoughts, Substack, Medium

Consuming: Books, Podcasts, Movies, TV

Presenting: Talks & Interviews

Publishing: Google Scholar

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Non-exhaustive list of technologies I've worked with in the past.

Python · Go · Java · Scala · C · C++ · Elixir · iOS · Android · Mobile Development · PostgreSQL · Kubernetes · GCP · Render · MQTT · PubSub · Hadoop MapReduce · Distributed Systems · Consensus Algorithms · API Integrations & Design · Agentic Payments · Integration Testing · Data Labeling · Test Sets · Tinker